

Proposed Bylaws Amendment - 01

Amend: Title III – Regulations Relative to Lodges; Chapter VIII: Work and Instruction; Section 8: Proficiency

WHEREAS, recent legislative changes have opened participation to Entered Apprentices & Fellowcrafts in ritual ceremonies which would call into question how much of this process they can participate in;

And WHEREAS, the word “committee” in masonic legislation in this jurisdiction has colloquially meant to be made up of members in full and good standing in a lodge and this committee is acting as a proxy of the Worshipful Master to inform his determination as to a candidates proficiency;

And WHEREAS, a candidate who is focusing on his own work and does not have the history and experience of coaching other candidates and therefore would not be an ideal judge of another candidates proficiency;

BE IT THEREFORE RESOLVED that SECTION 3-8-7. PROFICIENCY be amended as follows: (Proposed additions in **Red**)

No candidate shall be advanced to the second or to the third degree until after he shall have passed a satisfactory examination as to his proficiency in a Grand Lodge approved catechism of the preceding degree. Such examination shall be held either in open Lodge or before a committee of not less than two **Master Masons in good standing in a Lodge in this jurisdiction** appointed for that purpose. The proficiency of the candidate shall be decided by the Master. Each Master Mason must present himself for examination as to his proficiency in the Master Mason degree, including the Test Oath, within sixty days after having been raised, unless for good cause further time is granted by the Master.

No Master Mason raised in this Jurisdiction shall be entitled to a certificate of membership, or a receipt for dues, or a demit, or to vote in the Lodge, until he shall have been examined and found proficient in the catechism of the Master Mason Degree. Dues must be paid by all candidates commencing the first day of the month after they shall have been examined and found proficient in a Grand Lodge approved Catechism of the Master Mason Degree.

Respectfully Submitted,

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